

F5 Daily Briefing — Monday, May 25, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS
TRACKED

23

ANNOUNCEMENTS

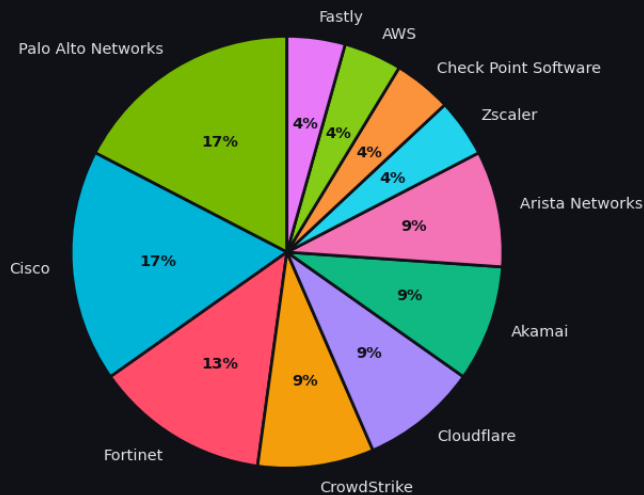
11

ACTIVE

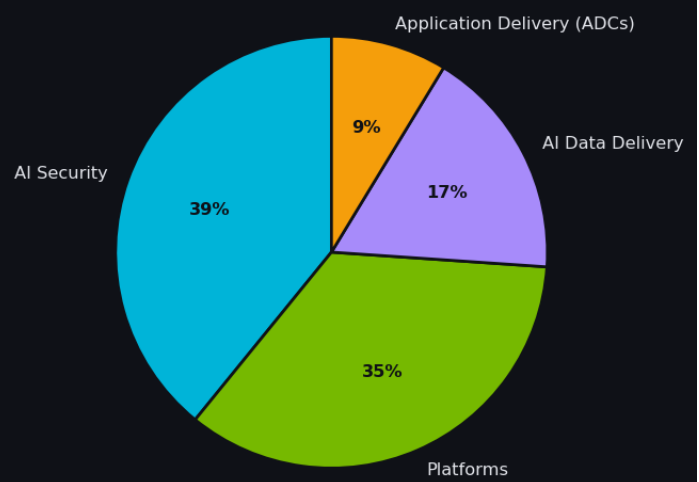
4

ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



Announcements by Category



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (23)

INDUSTRY RECOGNITION

Arista Networks

2026-05-23

Arista's Gartner Magic Quadrant Leadership Extends Story Beyond AI Data Centers Into Campus

Coverage on May 23, 2026 examined Arista Networks' position as a Leader in Gartner's 2026 Magic Quadrant for Enterprise Wired and Wireless LAN. New campus and industrial networking offerings include ruggedized switches and directional antenna access points, expanding Arista's market beyond data centers. The AVA platform is evolving into a multi-domain AIOps solution for automation across campus, data center, and cloud. The strategy positions Arista to compete with Cisco, HPE Aruba, and Juniper for campus refreshes, opening recurring-revenue opportunities across branch offices, HQs, and industrial sites with higher-margin software-driven revenue.

Source: <https://simplywall.st/stocks/us/tech/nyse-anet/arista-networks/news/aristas-gartner-win-extends-story-beyond-ai-data-centers-int>

SECURITY ADVISORY**Cisco**

2026-05-23

Critical Cisco SD-WAN Manager Vulnerability Exploited; CISA Issues Emergency Directive

Cisco disclosed exploitation of a critical SD-WAN Manager vulnerability tied to a highly sophisticated actor tracked by Cisco Talos as UAT-8616. Rapid7 identified the flaw while analyzing CVE-2026-20127. CISA issued Emergency Directive 26-03 mandating timely mitigations for federal agencies. Patches are available for all affected releases. Cisco recommends applying the patch immediately, rotating SSH keys for the vmanage-admin account, inspecting DTLS-based peer connections for anomalies, and segmenting SD-WAN management traffic. This marks the sixth exploited SD-WAN vulnerability in 2026, underscoring SD-WAN management infrastructure as a high-value attacker target.

Source: <https://www.networkworld.com/article/4176010/critical-vulnerability-in-cisco-secure-workload-rated-at-maximum-severity-2.html>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Check Point Software**

2026-05-22

Check Point Launches Agentic Network Security Orchestration Platform; Acquires Deepchecks Team and IP

Check Point unveiled its Agentic Network Security Orchestration Platform on May 22, 2026, an autonomous AI-driven system replacing rule-based complexity. A proprietary Network Knowledge Graph models topology, traffic, assets, and configurations in real time. Security teams define business intent; AI agents implement rule tightening, virtual patching, and policy actions under human oversight. Policy Auditor, Policy Insights, and AI Assist are available now; Playblocks Agents is in early availability with broader multi-vendor support in H2 2026. Check Point will also acquire the Deepchecks team and IP for AI evaluation, observability, testing, and monitoring of agent performance.

Source: <https://www.checkpoint.com/press-releases/check-point-launches-agentic-network-security-orchestration-platform-turning-months-of-manual-policy-work-into-minutes-of-verified-action/>

INDUSTRY RECOGNITION**CrowdStrike**

2026-05-22

CrowdStrike Named Overall Champion in Omdia 2026 Cybersecurity Platform Ecosystems Matrix

CrowdStrike was named Overall Champion in Omdia's 2026 Cybersecurity Platform Ecosystems Leadership Matrix, leading a 24-vendor field for ecosystem strength and platform impact. Highlights include MSSP contracts exceeding \$1.3B over three years, AWS Marketplace approaching \$1.5B in FY26, and expansion across Google Cloud and Microsoft marketplaces. Partner-led delivery spans Accenture, Deloitte, EY, Kroll, and Wipro. Deepening AI and hyperscaler collaborations (AWS, Google, Microsoft, NVIDIA, Anthropic, OpenAI, Perplexity), AI infrastructure ties (CoreWeave, Nebius), and EU sovereign cloud alignment with Schwarz Digits. Charlotte AI AgentWorks ecosystem enables partners to build and monetize AI security agents.

Source: <https://securitymea.com/2026/05/22/crowdstrike-named-overall-champion-by-omdia/>

CORPORATE UPDATE**Fortinet**

2026-05-22

Fortinet Highlights AI Data Centers, OT Security, Sovereign SASE Pipeline at JP Morgan Event

Fortinet's May 2026 update centers on AI-driven demand. CFO Christiane Ohlgart and CTO/PM Robert May briefed investors at a JP Morgan software event, noting a strong pipeline fueled by AI data center security, OT protection, and sovereign SASE offerings. Fortinet's ASICs deliver high performance, low latency, and low power critical for AI workloads. Sovereign SASE supports country-restricted data sovereignty, with early telecom and large financial customers. OT and SD-WAN/SASE bundles continue to drive upsells, and inventory remains at about two quarters of supply with expanded European warehouse capacity.

Source: <https://zolmax.com/investing/fortinet-sees-ai-data-centers-ot-security-and-sovereign-sase-fueling-pipeline/11861628.html>

RESEARCH REPORT**Fortinet**

2026-05-22

Fortinet-Commissioned Forrester Study: AI Threats Outpace Asia-Pacific Readiness

Fortinet released a Forrester Consulting study warning that cybersecurity complexity and AI-driven threats are outpacing organizational readiness in Malaysia and broader Asia Pacific. Findings: 70% of organizations see AI-driven threats as a major concern, 64% report fragmented security tools, 63% face excessive alert volumes, 55% struggle to distinguish real threats due to alert overload, 52% rely on manual workflows, and only 16% show advanced cybersecurity maturity. Fortinet recommends moving toward unified, platform-based security architectures to improve visibility, automate SOC functions, and enhance threat response, while weighing migration costs and integration challenges.

Source: <https://businessnews.com.my/fortinet-cybersecurity-ai-threats/>

PARTNERSHIP**Palo Alto Networks**

2026-05-22

Palo Alto Networks and UAE Sign MoU to Build National Cyber-Resilience Program

Palo Alto Networks and the UAE signed a Memorandum of Understanding to build a national cyber-resilience program. Key elements include establishing a Cybersecurity Centre of Excellence in the UAE, developing national cyber talent through tailored education, and using AI-driven automation to enhance the national CERT's visibility and incident response. The partnership advances resilience across critical infrastructure, cloud security, and incident response, with potential joint research in AI governance, post-quantum cryptography, and smart city security. Leaders from both sides emphasized strengthening digital resilience to support innovation, economic growth, and the UAE's secure digital future.

Source: <https://gecnewswire.com/uae-and-palo-alto-networks-to-build-national-cyber-resilient-ecosystem/>

SECURITY ADVISORY**Palo Alto Networks**

2026-05-22

Palo Alto Networks Discloses Critical PAN-OS User-ID/Captive Portal Vulnerability

Palo Alto Networks disclosed a critical PAN-OS vulnerability affecting the User-ID/Captive Portal feature (only when configured). An unauthenticated attacker could send crafted packets to potentially execute code with high privileges on affected PA-Series and VM-Series firewalls. Cloud NGFW, Prisma Access, and Panorama are not affected. Mitigations include disabling Captive Portal where not needed or restricting it to trusted internal IPs/zones. Palo Alto has acknowledged the vulnerability, issued mitigation guidance, and plans staged patches across PAN-OS branches from mid to late May 2026. Administrators are urged to apply updates promptly and minimize exposure.

Source: <https://darkgatemagazine.com/palo-alto-moves-quickly-after-critical-pan-os-exploit-emerges/>

ACQUISITION**Akamai**

2026-05-22

Akamai to Acquire LayerX for \$205M, Expanding Zero Trust with Secure Enterprise Browser and AI Usage Controls

Akamai signed a definitive agreement to acquire LayerX for approximately \$205 million, expanding its Zero Trust portfolio with browser-level AI usage controls and Secure Enterprise Browser capabilities. LayerX provides visibility and real-time governance over AI usage, web prompts, file uploads, and SaaS interactions inside popular browsers, including agentic browsers like Atlas and Comet, without changes to existing infrastructure. Akamai plans to keep LayerX standalone while integrating it into ZTNA, Guardicore Segmentation, Secure Internet Access Enterprise, and Enterprise Application Access. The deal is expected to close Q3 2026; LayerX is projected to reach ~\$10M ARR by year-end.

Source: <https://www.darkreading.com/remote-workforce/akamai-growing-chorus-betting-on-secure-enterprise-browsers>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Cisco**

2026-05-22

Cisco Integrates OpenAI Codex Into AI Defense Platform; Releases Open-Source DefenseClaw

Cisco integrated OpenAI's Codex into its AI Defense platform to accelerate security feature development. DJ Sampath, SVP/GM of AI Software and Platform, said Codex now writes nearly all new features. Cisco built DefenseClaw, an open-source AI security tool, in under a week using Codex. The integration enables faster development and quicker time-to-market for AI-driven security capabilities. The AI Defense platform provides asset and threat visibility across AI models, agents, and data to detect vulnerabilities and deploy countermeasures. Cisco emphasizes company-wide Codex adoption to better protect customers as AI systems become common attacker targets.

Source: <https://www.startuphub.ai/ai-news/artificial-intelligence/2026/cisco-leverages-openai-s-codex-for-ai-defense>

THOUGHT LEADERSHIP**Cisco**

2026-05-22

Cisco Outlines 5 Strategies to Close the AI Trust Gap

Cisco published guidance on five strategies to close the AI trust gap, focused on security and privacy to boost user confidence in AI deployments. Recommendations include implementing phishing-resistant MFA, strong identity verification, least-privilege access for AI agents, Zero Trust principles, patching, and asset visibility through solid configuration management. Cisco urges security teams to deploy AI to defend AI through threat hunting, conformance testing, digital twins, and validation, and to leverage agentic AI as a trusted virtual team member while maintaining safety. The piece emphasizes that closing the trust gap unlocks broader AI adoption across the enterprise.

Source: <https://newsroom.cisco.com/c/r/newsroom/en/us/a/y2026/m05/5-ways-to-close-the-ai-trust-gap.html>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Cloudflare**

2026-05-22

Cloudflare CASB Adds Claude Compliance API Support for AI Visibility and Governance

Cloudflare expanded CASB to support Anthropic's Claude Compliance API, monitoring Claude usage without inline inspection or endpoint agents. CASB surfaces security findings (misconfigurations, data-sharing risks) for Claude Projects, project attachments, and chat files directly in the Cloudflare dashboard. Findings integrate with existing CASB workflows to triage, remediate, and enforce policies via Cloudflare Gateway (block uploads, restrict access). Coverage spans Claude Enterprise (organizations, projects, chats, roles, read-only conversation content) and Claude Platform (member changes, API key events, file activity). Setup requires Claude Enterprise account, Compliance API access, and dashboard integration, with optional DLP scanning available.

Source: <https://blog.cloudflare.com/casb-anthropic-integration/>

PARTNERSHIP**CrowdStrike**

2026-05-22

CrowdStrike Integrates Claude Compliance API to Bring Claude Activity Into Falcon

CrowdStrike announced an integration with Anthropic's Claude Compliance API, bringing Claude Enterprise and Claude Platform activity into the Falcon platform. The integration ingests Claude activity logs and conversation content into Falcon Next-Gen SIEM and Charlotte Agentic SOAR, correlating AI usage with endpoint, identity, and cloud telemetry. Benefits include extended AI visibility within existing security operations, contextual detection, automated response via Charlotte Agentic SOAR, and policy-driven oversight through Falcon AI Detection and Response (AIDR) and Falcon Shield. Daniel Bernard emphasized treating AI activity like any other enterprise application to maintain comprehensive security coverage.

Source: <https://www.crowdstrike.com/en-us/press-releases/crowdstrike-delivers-visibility-and-monitoring-for-claude-activity/>

PARTNERSHIP**Fortinet**

2026-05-22

Fortinet Deepens Integration with NVIDIA to Secure Enterprise AI at Scale via FortiAI Gate

Fortinet announced an enhanced integration with NVIDIA to secure enterprise AI at scale. FortiAI Gate now leverages NVIDIA's AI platforms to protect AI workloads, data, and autonomous agents in real time across data centers and the cloud. Benefits include real-time threat monitoring, zero-trust security, governance, data sovereignty support, and minimal latency. Deployment options include on-premises, cloud, or hybrid as a GPU-powered virtual appliance or containers on NVIDIA-Certified Systems. The collaboration combines Fortinet's Security Fabric with NVIDIA's HPC and AI platforms, positioning both vendors to set a new standard for secure enterprise AI ecosystems.

Source: <https://www.ncnonline.net/fortinet-deepens-integration-to-uniquely-secure-enterprise-ai-at-scale-with-nvidia/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Palo Alto Networks**

2026-05-22

Palo Alto Networks Pushes 'Secure AI by Design' at AWS Summit Seoul

Palo Alto Networks is promoting its 'Secure AI by Design' strategy, unveiled at the AWS Summit in Seoul (May 21-22, 2026). The approach embeds security guardrails directly into cloud infrastructure from development, aiming to become the essential control plane for safely using AI on major cloud services like AWS. The push responds to tightening AI regulations (EU AI Act, South Korea AI Basic Act), Shadow AI incidents, and maturing cloud-native safety features. It positions Palo Alto Networks to capitalize on growing demand for compliant, architecture-level AI security ahead of EU AI Act applicability in August 2026.

Source: <https://dailyalpha.us/news/palo-alto-networks-pushes-secure-ai-by-design-at-aws-summit-targeting-cloud-native-ai-governance-6a1011313bd807efe50e0e68>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Palo Alto Networks**

2026-05-22

Palo Alto Networks Unveils Zero-Copy AI Firewall to Stop Hidden AI Data Leaks

Palo Alto Networks released its AI Firewall update emphasizing zero-copy data protection to block hidden AI leaks. The firewall monitors data requests at the source with real-time semantic tracking, preventing sensitive data from leaking into unauthorized AI model training pools. Zero-copy federation reduces data movement by processing information where it resides, lowering exposure risk. Protections target leaks through prompts, model memory, API calls, and automated workflows. The Strata Cloud Security Agent Data Leak Prevention 2026 strategy aims to secure AI systems without hindering productivity, providing tagging, automatic isolation triggers, regulatory compliance, and licensing guidance.

Source: <https://xthe.com/news/what-palo-alto-networks-zero-copy-ai-firewall-stops/>

ACQUISITION**Zscaler**

2026-05-22

Zscaler to Acquire Symmetry Systems to Strengthen AI Identity and Data Security

Zscaler signed a letter of intent to acquire Symmetry Systems, combining Symmetry's access-graph technology with the Zero Trust Exchange to govern AI agent communications. The deal provides visibility into how identities (human and AI), applications, and data interact, enabling policy enforcement at scale for autonomous agents. Symmetry inventories data assets across cloud, on-premises, and air-gapped environments, tagging sensitivity and monitoring access. For AI, the platform scans training datasets and monitors data ingested by AI agents. Financial terms were not disclosed; closing is expected in the coming days, addressing governance scalability for millions of AI agents.

Source: <https://www.techzine.eu/news/security/141547/zscaler-acquires-ai-security-firm-symmetry-systems/>

PARTNERSHIP**AWS**

2026-05-22

AWS Named Launch Cloud Partner for NVIDIA Vera Rubin NVL72 Rack-Scale System

NVIDIA confirmed its Vera Rubin NVL72 rack-scale system with AWS, Google Cloud, and Oracle Cloud named as launch cloud partners. AWS will be the first major cloud to offer NVIDIA RTX PRO 4500 Blackwell Server Edition, an inference-focused card with favorable throughput-per-token pricing. Microsoft is integrating NVL72 into its next Fairwater sites, while AI clouds CoreWeave, Lambda, Nebius, and Nscale join the ecosystem. The move signals hardware parity and scalable GPU capacity for large-scale inference workloads, pushing buyers toward Capacity Blocks and Reserved Instances for critical workloads as regional allocation remains uneven.

Source: <https://news.lavx.hu/article/aws-mcp-server-goes-ga-what-it-means-for-multi-cloud-ai-agent-strategies>

CORPORATE UPDATE**Arista Networks**

2026-05-22

Arista Stock Drops Despite Strong Backlog Signals; Supply Chain Pressures Near-Term Margins

Arista Networks stock fell on May 22, 2026 as lofty AI sector expectations weighed on shares despite a strong \$8.9B backlog signaling extraordinary demand visibility in AI data-center networking. Near-term margin pressure stems from supply-chain constraints and manufacturing bottlenecks, not weaker demand. Full-year revenue guidance was raised by \$250M to \$11.5B (+28% YoY) with \$3.5B from AI products. Deferred revenue grew to \$6.2B (+15% YoY) and purchase commitments to \$8.9B (+44%), reinforcing durable demand. Management guided conservatively due to temporary headwinds, suggesting margin expansion should resume once supply issues ease.

Source: <https://market-pulse.co/article/19917/anet-stock-plunges-despite-beating-earnings-is-the-ai-darling-now-a-bargain>

RESEARCH REPORT**Cisco**

2026-05-22

Cisco Report: AI Traffic Will Reshape WANs With 9x Enterprise Growth by 2035

Cisco's 'AI Impact on Wide Area Networks 2026' report finds agentic AI will radically reshape WAN traffic. AI inference traffic could grow 9x from current levels by 2029-2032 with a 25% CAGR. AI inference flows alter traffic shape, symmetry, duration, and criticality, making inference paths strategic assets that require high resilience, observability, and differentiated QoS and path security. AI inference traffic shows asymmetric upstream/downstream patterns and higher latency variability than traditional web traffic. Providers must monitor inference latency, manage QoS, plan for changing access network symmetry, and account for data sovereignty in inference routing.

Source: <https://www.networkworld.com/article/4175890/cisco-ai-traffic-is-radically-reshaping-wans.html>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Cloudflare**

2026-05-22

Cloudflare Launches Environments for Claude Managed Agents with Anthropic

Cloudflare and Anthropic launched Cloudflare Environments for Claude Managed Agents, pairing Claude AI with Cloudflare's infrastructure to run autonomous agent loops securely at scale. The control plane built on Cloudflare Workers creates isolated per-session sandboxes with default security and compliance controls. Features include outbound connection controls, secure access to private/internal services via Cloudflare Mesh or Workers VPC, audit trails, and session recordings for governance. Anthropic provides the Claude model layer while Cloudflare handles deployment, network scale, and security. Developers can choose microVM-based or lighter isolate-based sandboxes, with faster start times and high concurrency.

Source: <https://blog.cloudflare.com/claude-managed-agents/>

CORPORATE UPDATE**Fastly**

2026-05-24

Fastly AI-Fueled Edge Growth Highlighted; 2026 Guidance Raised to \$710-725M

Analyst coverage on May 24, 2026 highlighted Fastly's accelerating AI-driven edge growth. Compute and Observability revenue grew 67% year-over-year in Q1 2026, and management raised full-year 2026 revenue guidance to \$710-\$725 million. Newer services improve efficiency, although higher infrastructure and R&D spend may not yet yield profitability. Insider share sales appear largely compensation- or tax-related via pre-arranged plans rather than operational signals. The investment narrative envisions Fastly reaching approximately \$866.5M revenue and \$67.5M earnings by 2029, implying about 11.6% annual revenue growth from current levels.

Source: <https://simplywall.st/stocks/us/software/nasdaq-fsly/fastly/news/will-ai-fueled-edge-growth-and-insider-sales-shift-fastlys-f>

Akamai Raises \$3.5B in Zero-Coupon Convertible Senior Notes

Akamai completed a private placement of \$3.5 billion in zero-coupon convertible senior notes due 2030 and 2032, sold to qualified institutional buyers under Rule 144A. Initial Purchasers included JPMorgan, Citigroup, Morgan Stanley, BofA Securities, and Goldman Sachs. Proceeds funded convertible note hedge transactions (~\$236.6M) and repurchase of approximately 2.48 million Akamai shares (~\$350M). The 2030 notes convert at 4.9650 shares per \$1,000 principal (~\$201.41/share) maturing May 15, 2030; the 2032 notes convert at 5.2408 shares per \$1,000 (~\$190.81/share) maturing May 15, 2032. Remaining proceeds support future strategic transactions.

Source: <https://www.stocktitan.net/sec-filings/AKAM/8-k-akamai-technologies-inc-reports-material-event-ad95329a80ca.html>